

STAGE THREE • JOB APPLICATION & INTERVIEW SKILLS

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Three sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 20 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Three • Job Application & Interview Skills

OVERVIEW

Stage Three's manual presents its twenty FIRSTS as a flat list with no named sections. This Session Plan, along with the companion Facilitator Guide, organizes them into three sessions built around the natural arc of a job search: Building the Application, Interview Readiness, and Closing the Loop.

This stage works best with real, current materials — real job listings, real resumes, real upcoming interviews — rather than hypothetical examples. Encourage participants to bring their actual situation into every session where possible; for anyone not yet actively searching, a realistic scenario still builds the same habits.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Building the Application — C1-C7	~130 min
Session 2	Interview Readiness — C8-C14	~120 min
Session 3	Closing the Loop — C15-C20	~105 min

SESSION 1

Building the Application

Covers FIRSTS C1-C7: Job Application Tracker, Application Strategy, Resume Version A/B Test, Cover Letter Customization, Job Listing Analysis, STAR Answer Prep, Behavioral Interview Prep.

PRE-WORK

- Bring your current resume and, if you have one, a cover letter you've used before.
- Identify 2-3 real job or internship listings you're genuinely interested in.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome + framing: this session builds the operational backbone of a real search	Full group
0:10-0:30	FIRST C1 — Job Application Tracker: live setup + logging past applications	Solo, hands-on
0:30-0:50	FIRST C2 — Application Strategy: criteria + 5 target companies	Solo, then pairs strategy swap
0:50-1:10	FIRST C3 — Resume Version A/B Test: draft version 2	Solo
1:10-1:15	Short break	—
1:15-1:35	FIRST C4 — Cover Letter Customization: live customization against a real listing	Solo

1:35-1:55	FIRST C5 — Job Listing Analysis: group decode of a shared listing	Small groups
1:55-2:15	FIRST C6 — STAR Answer Prep: draft + round-robin storytelling	Solo, then small groups
2:15-2:35	FIRST C7 — Behavioral Interview Prep + close: rapid-fire practice	Pairs, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This session runs long by design — it's the foundation for everything after. Consider a 10-minute buffer beyond the ~130 minutes planned.
- FIRSTS C1 and C17 (deadline calendar, in Session 3) are related operational systems; if a participant sets up both today, that's fine and doesn't need to wait.

SESSION 2

Interview Readiness

Covers *FIRSTS C8–C14: Technical Interview Prep, Case/Problem-Solving Prep, Mock Interview, Job Offer Negotiation Prep, Follow-Up Email After Interview, Test/Assessment Prep, Mock Presentation.*

PRE-WORK

- Bring the STAR stories and behavioral answers prepared in Session 1.
- If your target field involves a specific technical or case-style interview, come ready to mention it.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today is about performing under real conditions, not just planning	Full group
0:10–0:30	FIRST C8 — Technical Interview Prep: identify format + timed practice problem	Solo
0:30–0:50	FIRST C9 — Case/Problem-Solving Prep: structure + narrate aloud	Solo, then pairs
0:50–1:00	Short break	—
1:00–1:30	FIRST C10 — Mock Interview: full panel simulation	Volunteer + panel, full group observes
1:30–1:50	FIRST C11 — Job Offer Negotiation Prep: research + role-play	Solo, then pairs
1:50–2:00	FIRST C12 — Follow-Up Email After Interview: template draft	Solo
2:00–2:10	FIRST C13 — Test/Assessment Prep: research + practice question	Solo
2:10–2:30	FIRST C14 — Mock Presentation + close: small-audience delivery	Small groups, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This is the most emotionally intensive session in the stage. Build in the short break and don't compress it, even if running slightly behind.
- The Mock Interview (C10) benefits from a volunteer who's comfortable being watched by the full group; if no one volunteers readily, don't force it — offer the paired version from the Group Versions document instead.

SESSION 3

Closing the Loop

Covers FIRSTS C15–C20: Interview Mindset Routine, Thank-You Email Habit, Application Deadline Calendar, Career-Focused LinkedIn Application, Job Research Sheet, Offer Comparison Matrix.

PRE-WORK

- If you have a real, current job search underway, bring your actual list of upcoming deadlines and any pending offers or follow-ups.
- No preparation needed if you don't currently have an active search.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today is everything around the interview, not the interview itself	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST C15 — Interview Mindset Routine: design + commit to testing it this week	Solo
0:25–0:35	FIRST C16 — Thank-You Email Habit: public commitment	Solo, then full-group share
0:35–0:50	FIRST C17 — Application Deadline Calendar: live setup	Solo, hands-on
0:50–0:55	Short break	—
0:55–1:15	FIRST C18 — Career-Focused LinkedIn Application: identify + draft outreach	Solo, laptops needed
1:15–1:35	FIRST C19 — Job Research Sheet: complete for a real or hypothetical interview	Solo
1:35–1:55	FIRST C20 — Offer Comparison Matrix + stage close: build template + outside perspective check	Solo, then pairs, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST C20 is the capstone of the entire stage — give it genuine room rather than rushing it if earlier segments ran long.
- Close the full stage by having each participant name one specific thing from this stage they're using in their very next real application or interview.
- This is a natural moment to preview Stage Four (Mindset, Productivity & Habits), which carries participants through the sustained discipline a job search, and the role after it, actually requires.